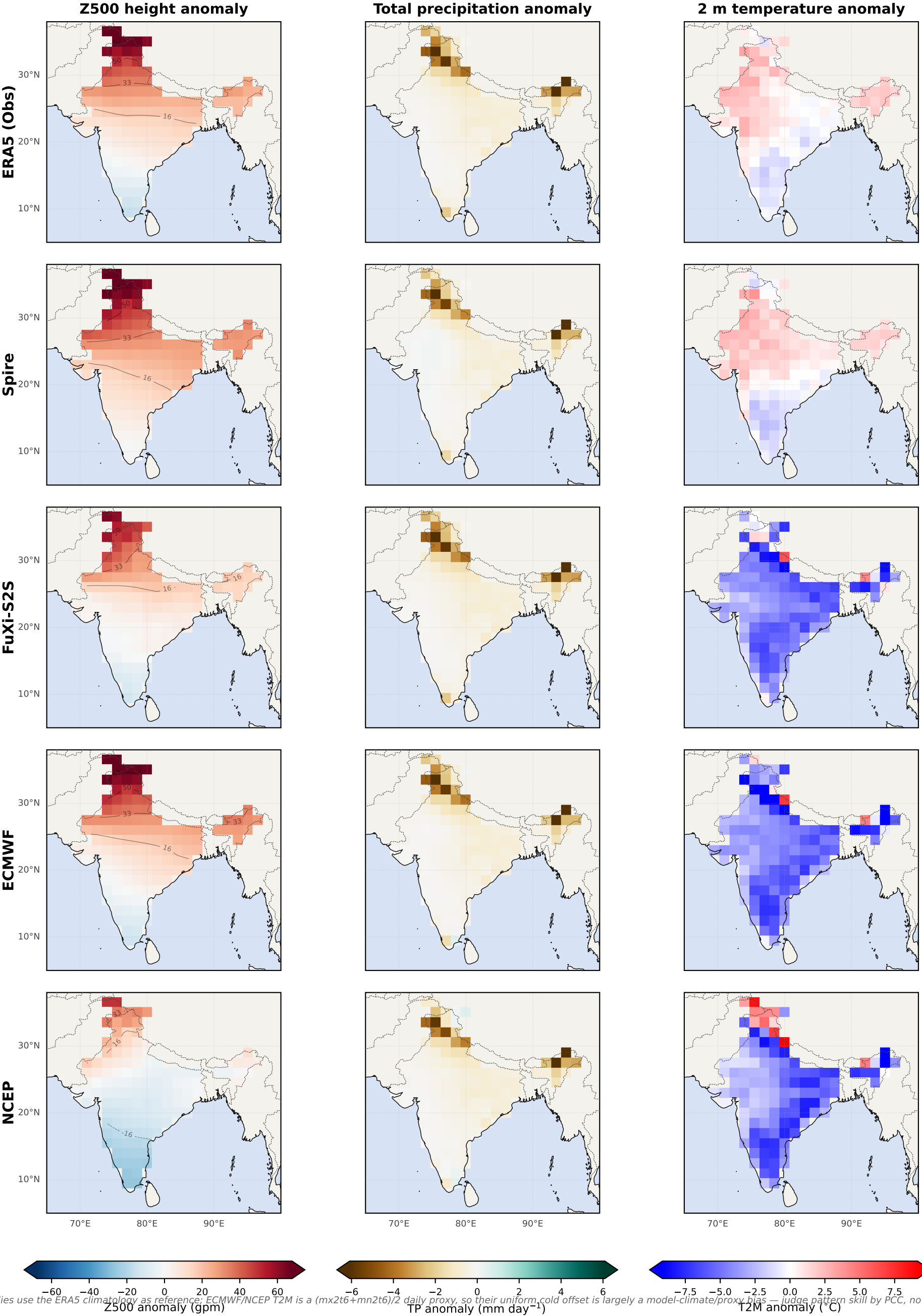


**Figure 2a — Multi-model spatial comparison, Week-1 lead (init 2026-02-12, Week 1)**  
**Valid 12-18 Feb 2026 · anomalies vs ERA5 climatology · India (IMD regions)**



*T2M anomalies use the ERA5 climatology as reference; ECMWF/NCEP T2M is a (mx2t6+mn2t6)/2 daily proxy, so their uniform cold offset is largely a model-climate/proxy bias — judge pattern skill by PCC, not mean bias.*